

IPKF soldiers in October 1989. The IPKF faced its first serious threat in September 1987, when riots broke out in Trincomalee; 15 MECHANISED was moved there post-haste, and a sector headquarters was established to contain the ethnic strife. The IPKF was thereafter to maintain a sizeable presence at Trincomalee during its stay in Sri Lanka. (Robert Nickelsberg/Getty Images)